Minutes of the Meeting of the Council of the Corporation of the Town of Ajax Held in the Council Chambers, Ajax Town Hall and Electronically on Monday, October 20, 2025

Alternative formats available upon request by contacting:
accessibility@ajax.ca or 905-619-2529 ext. 3347

Present:	Mayor	S. Collier
	Regional Councillors	M. Crawford
		S. Lee
		J. Dies
	Councillors	R. Tyler Morin
		N. Henry
		L. Bower

1. Call to Order & Acknowledgement of Traditional Treaty Lands

Mayor Collier called the meeting to order at 1:02 p.m. and acknowledged traditional treaty lands.

2. Disclosure of Pecuniary Interest

There were no disclosures of pecuniary interest.

Motion to Suspend the Rules of Procedure

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: M. Crawford

That the Rules of Procedure be suspended in order to hear an unscheduled delegation (Item 6.3).

CARRIED
on 2/3rds

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

3. Hearing of Complaint Under Section 20 of the Development Charges Act, 1997

A copy of the Decision and Reasons attached in accordance with Section 20 of the Development Charges Act, 1997 can be found on page 11 of the draft minutes.

3.1. Development Charges Complaint – 620 Taunton Road East, Ajax

3.1.1. Chair's Opening Statement

Mayor Collier, Chair, provided an overview of the purpose of the meeting and noted that the hearing is being held in accordance with the Development Charges Act, 1997.

3.1.2. Complainant Submission

John W. Montgomery, Solicitor, Johnston, Montgomery, Watson, Barristers & Solicitors, (Agent for Mikabco Holdings Inc.), delivered evidence and submissions in support of the complaint.

3.1.3. **Questions to Complainant**

Council Members asked questions related to the Complainant's submissions. Geoff Romanowski, Director of Planning & Development Services and J. Montgomery, responded to questions from Council Members.

3.1.4. **Town Submission: FIN-2025-20: Development Charges Complaint Pursuant to Section 20 of the Development Charges Act, 1997 – 620 Taunton Road East**

John Pappas, Aird & Berlis LLP, delivered submissions in support of the staff report and recommendations contained therein.

3.1.5. **Questions to Staff**

None.

3.1.6. **Reply Submissions**

None.

3.1.7. **Deliberation and Decision**

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: J. Dies

That, upon review of the evidence and submissions of the complainant, the Section 20 Development Charges Act complaint of 620 Taunton Rd East – Mikabco Holdings Inc., be hereby dismissed, as no error was made in the application of Town of Ajax Development Charges By-law, and the amount of applicable development charges was correctly determined in accordance with the Development Charges Act, 1997 (DCA) as well as the Town's Development Charges (DC) By-law.

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

3.1.8. **Adjournment**

The hearing adjourned at 1:33 p.m.

4. Adoption of the Minutes

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin
Seconded by: M. Crawford

That the minutes of the Regular Meeting of Council held on September 15, 2025 be adopted.

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

5. Question Period

Mayor Collier invited questions on agenda items from those present.

6. Delegations, Presentations, and Public Meetings

6.1. Delegation: Greenwood Conservation Lands – Background

Dave Meredith, Director of Operations & Environmental Services, delivered a delegation related to Greenwood Conservation Lands.

Questions to staff were postponed until after Item 6.2.

6.2. Presentation: Greenwood Conservation Lands

Emily Markovic, Senior Manager, Government & Community Relations, Toronto and Region Conservation Authority, delivered a presentation related to Greenwood Conservation Lands.

Council Members asked questions related to the presentation. E. Markovic and Deanna Cheriton, Senior Manager, Conservation Lands, Toronto and Region Conservation Authority, responded to questions from Council Members.

6.1. Delegation: Greenwood Conservation Lands – Background

Council Members asked questions related to the delegation. D. Meredith responded to questions from Council Members.

6.3. Delegation: Ajax GO Station Lands and Visioning Survey Results

Douglas Glass, Ajax Resident, delivered a delegation related to Ajax GO Station Lands and Visioning Survey Results.

Council Members asked questions related to the delegation. D. Glass and G. Romanowski, responded to questions from Council Members.

7. Correspondence

8. Reports

8.1. Community Affairs & Planning Committee Report

8.1.1. Community Affairs & Planning Committee, October 6, 2025

Moved by: S. Collier
Seconded by: S. Lee

That Item 5.1 of the Community Affairs & Planning Committee Report dated October 6, 2025, be voted on separately.

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: S. Lee

That the balance of the Community Affairs & Planning Committee Report dated October 6, 2025 be adopted.

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

Item 5.1 PDS-2025-24: Ajax GO Station Secondary Plan: Background Report and Land Use Concepts

Council Members asked questions related to the proposed amendment. Kassandra Brownridge, Manager of Strategic Initiatives, Sean McCullough, Supervisor of Policy Planning & Research, and G. Romanowski, responded to questions from Council Members.

Main Motion

Moved by: S. Collier
Seconded by: S. Lee

1. That the Report entitled, “Ajax GO Station Secondary Plan: Background Report and Land Use Concepts” be received for information;

2. That staff be authorized to schedule consultation meetings to seek input from the public, Indigenous Communities, and other key stakeholders on the proposed land use concepts and policy considerations; and

3. That a copy of this Report be forwarded to the Canada Mortgage and Housing Corporation.

Amendment

Moved by: S. Collier
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

That clause 2 of the Resolution for Item 5.1 in the October 6, 2025 Community Affairs & Planning Committee Report be amended to read as follows:

2. That staff be authorized to schedule consultation meetings to seek input from the public, Indigenous Communities, and other key stakeholders on the proposed land use concepts and policy considerations, while also introducing a range of building heights (including options that exceed 35 stories), in order to explore higher densities in alignment with provincial and federal direction.

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

Main Motion as Amended

Moved by: S. Collier
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

1. That the Report entitled, “Ajax GO Station Secondary Plan: Background Report and Land Use Concepts” be received for information;

2. That staff be authorized to schedule consultation meetings to seek input from the public, Indigenous Communities, and other key stakeholders on the proposed land use concepts and policy considerations, while also introducing a range of building heights (including options that exceed 35 stories), in order to explore higher densities in alignment with provincial and federal direction.

3. That a copy of this Report be forwarded to the Canada Mortgage and Housing Corporation.

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

8.2. **General Government Committee Report**

8.2.1. **General Government Committee, October 14, 2025**

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin
Seconded by: S. Lee

That the General Government Committee Report dated October 14, 2025, be adopted.

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

8.3. **Departmental Reports**

None.

9. Regional Councillors' Report

None.

10. Business Arising from Notice of Motion

10.1 **Advocating for Expansion of the Canada-Wide Early Learning and Child Care (CWELCC) Program**

Councillor Henry introduced the motion and reviewed its contents.

Moved by: N. Henry
Seconded by: M. Crawford

Whereas, the Canada-Wide Early Learning and Child Care (CWELCC) agreement between the Government of Canada and the Province of Ontario is set to expire on March 31, 2026; and

Whereas, CWELCC has significantly improved affordability and access to licensed child care for families in Ajax and across Ontario with fees currently capped at $22 per day and a goal of $10 per day by 2026; and

Whereas, in Ajax alone there are 55 child care centers enrolled in the CWELCC system, for a combined total of 3,506 child care spaces for children aged zero up to 6 years; and

Whereas, Minister of Education Paul Calandra has informed parents that additional federal funding is needed for the CWELCC agreement to meet its goal, and both levels of government are currently negotiating its renewal beyond 2026; and

Whereas, a renewed and increased federal government commitment to the CWELCC program is required to deliver on the promise of $10 per day child care beyond March 31, 2026. The provincial government has reaffirmed its dedication to maintaining its share of funding, ensuring that affordable, high-quality child care remains accessible to families across the province; and

Whereas, without adequate funding, Ontario families could see fees rise above $22/day starting April 1, 2026, and continue to rise thereafter; and

Whereas, simply maintaining the CWELCC program at its current level is insufficient. For instance, the child care system in Durham Region can presently accommodate approximately 35% of the eligible population, leaving many families on waitlists for as long as three years to secure a child care space. With our population expected to grow significantly in the coming years, expanding the program is essential to meet increasing demand and ensure all families have access to affordable, high-quality child care; and

Whereas, the current CWELCC funding model, while transformative, requires long-term federal and provincial commitments to ensure its sustainability and to support the creation of additional not-for-profit child care spaces in underserved areas;

Therefore, be it resolved:

1. That Ajax Council formally advocate to the Governments of Canada and Ontario and Regional Municipality of Durham for the renewal and expansion of the CWELCC agreement beyond March 31, 2026, with a focus on:

    - Long-term, stable, and adequate funding commitments;
    - Increased investment in early childhood educator recruitment, retention, and compensation;
    - Prioritization of child care space creation in high-growth and underserved communities such as Westney Heights in Ajax;
    - Ensuring a minimum of 70% of new spaces are in not-for-profit or public child care settings; and

2. That a copy of this motion be sent to Patty Hajdu, federal Minister of Jobs and Families, Anna Gainey, federal Secretary of State (Children and Youth), Sean Fraser, Federal Minister of justice, Doug Ford, Premier of Ontario, Paul Calandra, provincial Minister of Education, Jennifer McKelvie, MP for Ajax, Rob Cerjanec MPP for Ajax, John Henry, Regional Municipality of Durham Chair, and all lower tier Durham Region municipal councils.

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

10.2 **Provincial Decision on Automated Speed Enforcement (ASE)**

Regional Councillor Lee and Councillor Tyler Morin introduced the motion and reviewed its contents.

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

Whereas, the Province of Ontario filed enabling regulations in December 2019, to prescribe the locations, fines, and signage for municipalities to utilize Automated Speed Enforcement Cameras (ASE) as a tool to address speeding and improve public safety; and

Whereas, the Province’s ASE legislative framework, together with provincial encouragement in 2019, has led municipalities such as Ajax to implement ASE technology to improve safety, reduce speeding, and prevent serious collisions and fatalities; and

Whereas, the Provincial government, through the Ministry of Transportation, is responsible for the legislation, regulations and program standards governing municipal ASE programs; and

Whereas, some cities have implemented ASE programs without appropriate restraint, Ajax is part of the vast majority of municipalities who have implemented best practices endorsed by the Ministry of Transportation and the Ontario Traffic Council - including speed thresholds, advanced signage and public notification of ASE camera locations - that prioritize public safety while also ensuring transparency in the program, resulting in safer roads; and

Whereas, consistent with local, regional, national and international research, the Town of Ajax's ASE program has resulted in significant reductions in speed, increased speed compliance in Community Safety and School Zones, and changes in driver behaviour as outlined in the October 23, 2023, Council report titled "Automated Speed Enforcement (ASE) Program Update"; and

Whereas, the Town of Ajax has not generated any net revenue from the Automated Speed Enforcement program. However, the Town has made considerable investments into resources and infrastructure to support this program, and entered into service agreements that cannot easily be cancelled; and

Whereas, despite clear evidence and proven results from municipalities like Ajax, municipalities were caught off guard by the Premier's sudden announcement to cancel ASE programs across the province, made without adequate notice and consultation; and

Whereas, the Premier's concerns regarding ASE can be addressed through amendments to provincial legislation, regulations and program standards that enable municipalities to utilize ASE within prescribed guidelines, without an outright ban on the technology; and

Whereas, on September 10, 2025, Mayor Collier wrote a letter to Premier Doug Ford calling on the continuation of ASE and offered to meet to highlight how these programs can be implemented with appropriate restraint and serve as valuable tools for improving safety that are supported by local residents.

Therefore, be it resolved:

1. That Ajax Council formally opposes the Province's decision to abruptly cancel ASE, a public safety tool enabled through provincial regulations in December 2019; and

2. That Ajax Council requests the Provincial government to amend their legislation, regulations, and program standards governing ASE as follows:

    a) Restrict the use of ASE to School locations

    b) Use of ASE in areas that do not contain schools must be approved by the Minister of Transportation, supported by data clearly Internal demonstrating the need and a description of why alternative traffic calming measures are not suitable for the location.

    c) Develop a revised fee schedule for ASE tickets that reduces the cost for lower speed infractions while maintaining higher penalties for excessive speeding and stunt driving

    d) Develop new signage to include language indicating that the location is speed camera enforced

    e) Develop more visible ASE signage that includes the speed limit

    f) That the Ministry of Transportation provide greater oversight and enforcement of Municipal ASE programs through regular audits; and

3. That should the provincial government proceed with banning the use of ASE despite Ajax and other municipalities immediate actions to address concerns and requests to work collaboratively with the Province and other municipalities to continue these programs, the Province be requested to reimburse municipalities for all costs incurred to implement ASE program; and

4. That a copy of this resolution be sent to the Doug Ford, Premier of Ontario, Prabmeet Sarkaria, Minister of Transportation, Rob Cerjanec, MPP for Ajax, local MPPs across the Region of Durham, John Henry, Chair of the Regional Municipality of Durham, the Regional Municipality of Durham, all Ontario Municipalities, the Association of Municipalities of Ontario (AMO), the Ontario Association of Chiefs of Police (OACP), and the Ontario Traffic Council.

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

10.3 **Mental Health and Addictions Urgent Care and Emergency Department**

Regional Councillor Lee and Mayor Collier introduced the motion and reviewed its contents.

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: S. Collier

Whereas, a 24/7 Mental Health and Addictions Urgent Care and Emergency Department is needed in Durham Region to address a critical system gap to ensure the right care in the right place by providing immediate, specialized support for individuals in crisis and assist to reduce the pressures on emergency departments and first responders; and

Whereas, Lakeridge Health has a ready-to-announce Ontario Health endorsed project proposal to deliver a transformational approach to high-quality urgent and emergency mental health & addictions care through the establishment of a MHA Urgent Care Clinic, an MHA Emergency Department and an After-Care team, along with a MHA hub at Lakeridge Health Oshawa supported by spokes in high priority neighbourhoods, all of which are complementary and supportive of the HART Hub initiative; and

Whereas, Lakeridge Health Oshawa has space for and a commitment to this proposal, but requires a $30 million initial capital investment; and

Whereas, the Region of Durham and the City of Oshawa are committed to seeing this project materialize as evidenced by the many delegations made to the Provincial Government requesting approval and funding support; and

Whereas, through discussions with other Ontario municipalities that have successfully secured funding for similar initiatives, it was determined that the Provincial Government is more responsive to communities willing to make a funding commitment. Accordingly, at September 10, 2025, Committee of the Whole Meeting, the Region of Durham demonstrated its dedication to advancing this project by committing up to $2.25 million in the 2026 budget;

Therefore, be it resolved:

1. That Ajax Council formally support and endorse Lakeridge Health’s proposal to add a 24/7 Mental Health and Addictions Urgent Care and Emergency Department to Lakeridge Health Oshawa; and

2. That a copy of this resolution be sent to the Doug Ford, Premier of Ontario, Sylvia Jones, Minister of Health, Rob Cerjanec, MPP for Ajax, local MPPs across the Region of Durham, John Henry, Chair of the Regional Municipality of Durham, the

Regional Municipality of Durham, and all Durham Region municipalities.

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

10.4 **Reviewing Ajax's Rented Temperature Dwelling By-law**

Councillor Bower and Regional Councillor Dies introduced the motion and reviewed its contents.

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: J. Dies

Whereas, with rising global temperatures and increasingly frequent extreme heat events, protecting people from the harmful effects of heat exposure has become a critical public health priority; and

Whereas, heat waves can be deadly, particularly for those without adequate access to cooling, like lower-income individuals and renters, seniors, children, and people living with chronic illnesses; and

Whereas, community members have directly expressed concern with the Town's Rented Temperature Dwelling By-law, specifically the timeline of required air conditioning between June 1 – September 14; and

Whereas, May 2024 was, on average, the warmest May in recorded history, and capped the twelfth consecutive month of record global heat; and

Whereas, given that more than 85% of Ontario's population resides in urban areas, the effects of climate change impact urban dwellers disproportionately, particularly Indigenous Peoples, people of colour, and low-income residents; and

Whereas, heat stress can begin to affect humans at ambient temperatures above approximately 27° C. However, the exact threshold can vary depending on factors such as humidity, air circulation, and individual factors like clothing and activity level; and

Whereas, the process for buildings with multiple dwelling units is a lengthy process that requires coordination of contracted services that can't be easily switched between heating and cooling systems.

Therefore, be it resolved:

1. That Ajax Council direct Corporate Services staff to review temperature trends in the months of May and September for 2025 and the last four years; and

2. That staff report back to Council their recommendations on whether to adjust the Rented Dwellings Temperature By-law timeline (June 1 – Sept 14), and

3. That the report include how much time would be needed to phase in any recommendations, and the Town's ability to enforce this with its current staffing compliment; and

4. That the report be brought back to Council in Q1 2026 to implement any changes before May 2026.

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

11. By-laws

Moved by: J. Dies
Seconded by: N. Henry

That By-laws 75-2025 to 81-2025 be approved.

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

12. Notice of Motion

None.

13. New Business - Notices & Announcements

Council Members highlighted upcoming community events and matters of community interest.

14. Confirming By-Law

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin
Seconded by: N. Henry

That By-law 82-2025 being a by-law to confirm the proceedings of the Council of the Corporation of the Town of Ajax at its regular meeting held on October 20, 2025, be approved.

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

15. Adjournment

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin
Seconded by: M. Crawford

That the October 20, 2025 meeting of the Council of the Town of Ajax be adjourned (3:02 p.m.)

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

_____
Mayor and CEO

_____
Clerk